



ÁLEX MÉNDEZ

PRODUCT DESIGNER • DESIGN ENGINEER

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Product Designer & Design Engineer

12+ years shipping design systems and SaaS products in fintech. I own the full design-to-code pipeline – token architecture, component libraries, Storybook integration – and treat front-end constraints as design inputs, not afterthoughts. Currently the only designer at a global fintech platform operating in 160+ countries.

Key Achievements

40%	Reduced design-to-development handoff at Ria by building the design system from zero – token architecture, 40+ components, contribution guidelines.
10K–100K	Agents using the B2B SaaS platform I designed solo, operating across 160+ countries.
60+	Production components built for Openbank (Santander Group) with 3-layer token architecture and full parity with an 8-person React team.
~30%	Low-value components cut at Openbank after instrumenting the design system with usage analytics to sharpen roadmap priorities.

Experience

Mar 2023 – Present	Ria Money Transfer • Euronet Lead Product Designer • Sole Designer - Lead the design system that didn't exist before I joined – token architecture, 40+ production components, contribution guidelines – cutting design-to-dev handoff by 40%. - Only designer on a B2B SaaS platform serving 10,000–100,000 agents across 160+ countries; every component, pattern and decision is mine. - Set WCAG 2.1 AA as the non-negotiable accessibility standard; ran audits, fixed violations, and embedded the process into the design-to-code workflow so it doesn't regress. - Established a shared token language between design and front-end – now the single source of truth, implemented live in Storybook. - Introduced design system practice into an organisation that had none: documented contribution guidelines, component governance and review process from scratch.
	Senior UX/UI Designer • May 2022 – Feb 2023 Joined with no design system in place – audited the existing backoffice, identified inconsistencies, and laid the groundwork for the token architecture built in the Lead role.
Apr 2020 – May 2022	Openbank • Santander Group Design System Specialist + UI Analytics Sr. Analyst - Architected a production design system for Spain's largest digital-native bank: 3-layer token system, 60+ documented components, full parity with an 8-person React team. - Instrumented the design system with usage analytics; used adoption data to cut ~30% of low-value components and sharpen roadmap priorities. - Defined the contribution process, review cadence and breaking-change protocol – the workflows the front-end team still operates on.
Nov 2016 – Apr 2020	Globant Senior User Interface Designer - Led UI design for Movistar (telco) and Openbank (fintech) – two of Spain's largest digital products – owning the full process from brief to dev handoff. - Owned end-to-end UX delivery: research, information architecture, interaction design and high-fidelity prototyping.
Feb 2012 – Nov 2016	ZED Worldwide UI & UX Designer Designed mobile and web products across entertainment, telecoms and digital services – full-cycle ownership from research through high-fidelity prototyping.

Skills & Tools

Design Systems	Product Design	Design Engineering	Tools
- Token Architecture - Component Libraries - Multi-brand Governance - Documentation & Governance	- UX Research - Information Architecture - Interaction Design - High-fidelity Prototyping	- HTML / CSS - Design Tokens - Style Dictionary - React Collaboration - WCAG 2.1 AA Auditing	- Figma Advanced + Variables - Tokens Studio - Storybook - Style Dictionary - Adobe CC

Education

Advanced Digital Product Design MrMarcel School • 2022–23	Scrum Master Certification LinkedIn Learning • 2019
UX Research & Strategy Redbility • 2019	Web Design & Digital Art Instituto Cibernos